

MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

FROM RELIGIOUS DIVISION TO THE ARMADA: HOW DID ELIZABETH SECURE HER THRONE?

*Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88 – Key
Topic 3: Elizabethan society in the Age of
Exploration, 1558-88*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT3.1: Education and leisure			
L2: KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty			
L3: KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery			
L4: KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT3.1: Education and leisure

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the purpose of Elizabethan education and the influence of Humanist thinking and the printing press.
- ☐ Analyse how the schooling system (Petty schools, Grammar schools, and Universities) was strictly divided by class and gender.
- ☐ Explain the differences in leisure and sports between the nobility and the lower classes, including the universal popularity of 'cruel sports'.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the sudden explosion of the Elizabethan theatre and why it provoked such fierce opposition from Puritans and city authorities.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who led the Spanish Armada?

What was the Armada's plan?

What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish defensive formation at Calais?

What was the decisive sea battle of the Armada called?

What role did the weather play in defeating the Armada?

What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?

When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?

What was the Treaty of Nonsuch?

Who was Francis Walsingham?

What was the Book of Common Prayer?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least TWO of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Grammar School | Pastimes

Q1. What was the primary purpose of education in Elizabethan England?

Q2. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Petty Schools taught basic literacy, BUT...

Q3. How did leisure activities highlight the divide in Elizabethan society?

Q4. Why did the theatre become so incredibly popular during this era?

Q5. Vocabulary in Context: What was the 'Great Chain of Being'?

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did Elizabethan education improve society or simply reinforce class divisions?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools.

Q8. Describe one feature of Elizabethan Petty Schools.

Q9. Describe one feature of the Elizabethan theatre.

Q10. Describe one feature of Elizabethan sport and pastimes.

Q11. Explain why there was an increase in the number of schools in early Elizabethan England. Stimulus: Humanism / Growth of trade and business

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Q12. 'The theatre was the most popular form of entertainment for all classes.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The groundlings / Royal patronage

Q13. 'There was little change in education in Early Elizabethan England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Petty schools / Education for girls



Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L2: KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the economic and demographic causes of the poverty crisis, focusing on population growth, inflation, and the devastating impact of enclosure.
- ☐ Analyse contemporary Tudor attitudes towards the poor, specifically the strict division between the 'deserving' (impotent) and 'undeserving' (able-bodied) poor.
- ☐ Explain the reasons behind the public terror of vagabonds.
- ☐ Evaluate the significance of Elizabeth's changing policies, specifically the 1572 Vagabonds Act and the 1576 Poor Relief Act.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Name two types of schools in Elizabethan England.

What was a typical subject studied at Grammar school?

What was a popular cruel animal sport during this period?

Name one famous Elizabethan theatre.

Were women allowed to act on the Elizabethan stage?

Who led the Spanish Armada?

What was the Battle of Gravelines?

What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?

What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

What was the 'Great Chain of Being'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Vagabond / Vagrant Enclosure Impotent Poor Able-Bodied Poor Poor Rate
--

Your Sentence:

Q1. Identify two major causes of the poverty crisis in Elizabethan England.

Q2. Why did the Elizabethan government fear 'vagabonds'?

Q3. Causal Linkage: How did the government's approach to poverty change over time?

Q4. Diamond Ranking Challenge: What was the most significant cause of poverty? (A) Population growth (B) Enclosure (C) Bad harvests. Justify your choice.

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did poverty increase so rapidly during Elizabeth's reign?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act.

Q7. Describe one feature of the 1576 Poor Relief Act.

Q8. Describe one feature of the Houses of Correction.

**Q9. Explain why there was an increase in poverty in the years 1558–88. Stimulus:
Unemployment / Bad harvests**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 28 horizontal blue lines spaced evenly across the page, typical of standard notebook paper. The lines are thin and light blue, set against a plain white background. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Q10. 'The main reason for the increase in poverty in the years 1558–88 was the increasing population of England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Demand for food / Enclosure and sheep farming

 Pupil Voice

Which part of today's lesson did you find the most difficult or confusing, and what did you do to overcome it?

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L3: KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the factors that prompted Elizabethan exploration, focusing on new technology, expanding trade, and privateering.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the globe.
- ☐ Analyse the reasons behind Walter Raleigh's attempts to colonise Virginia.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the Virginia colonies, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish war.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was a 'vagrant' or 'vagabond'?

What were the 'deserving poor'?

What were the 'idle poor'?

What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?

What caused poverty to rise in this period?

What was a typical subject studied at a Grammar school?

Were women allowed to act on stage?

What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish formation at Calais?

What was a 'privateer'?

What was the Act of Supremacy?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Circumnavigation**

Q1. Why did England suddenly become interested in global exploration during Elizabeth's reign?

Q2. What were the main goals of Francis Drake's circumnavigation?

Q3. Vocabulary in Context: Why was Drake considered a 'privateer' rather than a pirate by the English?

Q4. Constrained Summary: Summarise the impact of Drake's voyage in one sentence.

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What was the main motivation for Elizabethan exploration?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Describe one feature of Francis Drake’s circumnavigation of the globe.

Q7. Describe one feature of the impact of new technology on Elizabethan exploration.

**Q8. Explain why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88. Stimulus:
Navigational instruments / Drive to expand trade**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]

[illegible]

Q9. 'New technology was the main reason why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Quadrant and astrolabe / Privateering profits

[illegible]

Q10. 'Drake's most significant achievement, in the years 1558–88, was his circumnavigation of the globe.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Golden Hind / Raid on Cadiz



Pupil Voice

If you were teaching this lesson to Year 6, what is the ONE most important thing you would make sure they remembered?

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L4: KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of Sir Walter Raleigh in planning, promoting, and financing the Virginia colonies.
- ☐ Analyse the economic, political, and strategic reasons for the attempted colonisation of North America.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the 1585 and 1587 expeditions, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish Armada.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did English sailors explore the world?

What new technology helped Elizabethan exploration?

Who was the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe (1577-1580)?

Who did Elizabeth give a patent to colonize North America in 1584?

Why did the first Roanoke settlement (1585) fail?

What happened to the second Roanoke settlement (1587)?

What caused poverty to rise in the Elizabethan period?

What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?

Who led the Spanish Armada?

What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Royal Charter Virginia Roanoke Algonquian
--

In 1584, Elizabeth I granted Walter Raleigh a [.] giving him exclusive rights to explore and colonize any lands not held by a Christian prince. Raleigh organized an ambitious expedition to establish a permanent colony in North America, naming the vast territory [.] in honor of the 'Virgin Queen'. The settlers landed on [.] Island, but the colony was doomed by poor planning and increasingly hostile relations with the local [.] Native American tribes, leading to the mysterious disappearance of the colonists.

Q1. What was Sir Walter Raleigh's grand ambition for North America?

Q2. Causal Linkage: Why did the first 1585 expedition to Roanoke fail?

Q3. What happened to the 1587 'Lost Colony'?

Q4. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Raleigh's colony was a complete disaster, BUT...

Pair & Share Activity

Q5. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did the Roanoke colony fail?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Describe one feature of the failure of the first Virginia colony.

Q7. Describe one feature of Sir Walter Raleigh's role in the attempted colonisation of Virginia.

Q8. Explain why the first colony in Virginia failed. Stimulus: Native Americans / Damage to The Tiger

[12 marks • 15 mins]

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 28 horizontal blue lines spaced evenly across the page, typical of standard notebook paper. The lines are thin and light blue, set against a plain white background. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

Q9. Explain why there was an attempt to colonise Virginia in 1585. Stimulus: Sir Walter Raleigh / New trade routes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

[illegible]

Q10. 'Poor planning was the main reason why the first colony in Virginia failed.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The choice of colonists / Lack of food supplies



What is one question about today's topic that we didn't answer, that you'd like to research further?

Page 34 of 36

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England (1558–88)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)